

PARENT TIPS

Feeling left out

Parents can feel left out when a teen's friendships start to become more important to them than before.

Encouraging teens to bring friends home can help parents to still feel involved and in the know about their teen's friends. Keeping in touch by phone when teens are out with friends can help alleviate any worries.



Laughing together can ignite a new friendship or strengthen an existing one.



Discovering new places with a friend brings excitement to the friendship.



A friend can give a person confidence to try new things and offer encouragement in new activities.

**Dealing with difficulties**

When arguments or other problems arise between friends, it can feel like the end of the world. However, part of growing up is learning how to manage friendships when they become tricky.

Jealousy

Lots of things can make people jealous, such as when friends get better grades at school or develop a new friendship with someone else. Jealousy can make people unkind to others. Often, just talking about these feelings can help.

Isolation and feeling left out

When friendships begin to drift apart, a teen might feel excluded and not recognize what is happening. Friendships can often be repaired by letting others know that their behavior is hurtful. If they continue to be negative, it might be better to invest in friendships that are more welcoming.

Oversharing

Revealing intimate details about life experiences and sharing secrets can create powerful bonds. Occasionally, someone who seems like a friend will exploit this closeness and use the information told in confidence to spread rumors. If a teen knows a friend is prone to gossip and not worthy of trust, then that friend is probably not someone to confide in.

Toxic relationships

Some young people come to realize that they're friends with someone who they dislike or who is a rival in some way. They may feel that they need to keep this person close, but severing ties can release them from an unhealthy relationship, especially if it's causing emotional or psychological harm.